Claude Design Masterclass

This guide summarizes the workflows, features, best practices, and token-saving strategies for getting the most out of Claude Design, Anthropic's AI-powered design product for building branded websites, slide decks, prototypes, animations, and launch videos using natural language.

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I. What Is Claude Design?

Claude Design is a separate product within the Anthropic ecosystem (alongside Claude Chat, Cowork, and Claude Code), released April 17, 2026, and powered by Claude Opus 4.7, Anthropic's most capable vision model. People have called it the "Figma killer."

What you can build

- Slide decks and pitch decks
- Websites and landing pages (wireframe or high-fidelity)
- Mobile and desktop app prototypes (interactive)
- Animated launch videos and motion graphics
- One-pagers, brand guidelines, and full design systems

Key advantages

- Branded, consistent output every time using a saved design system
- Built-in verifier agent: Opus 4.7 visually checks each page after generation and self-corrects
- Design systems can be shared across your team for consistent visuals (internal or external)
- Export anywhere: ZIP, PDF, HTML, Claude Code, Canva, PowerPoint, or Figma

Access requirements

Available on paid plans only (Pro, Max, Team, Enterprise). Free users must upgrade to use it. Higher plans get more weekly Claude Design usage.

II. The Two-Meter Usage System (Critical)

This is the most important detail to internalize: Claude Design has its own weekly usage quota, completely separate from your regular Claude Chat and Claude Code limits. Many users burn through it quickly without realizing they were on a different meter.

In your usage screen, you will see four meters

- Current session
- All Models (Chat plus Code)
- Sonnet only
- Claude Design (the separate one to watch)

Approximate burn rate by plan

- Pro ($20/mo): One big website plus one big design system can almost finish your weekly quota
- Max 5x: Roughly four to five serious prompts before getting close to the limit
- Max 20x ($200/mo): Multiple websites and a few video projects before nearing the limit

When you hit the limit

- Wait for the weekly reset, or
- Purchase extra usage (deducted from your account balance), or
- Export the project to Claude Code and continue iterating there (different meter)

III. The Foundation: Build a Design System First

The single most important first step in Claude Design is building ONE clean design system before doing anything else. Don't build five. Build one, build it well, and then iterate on it over time. Every project you create afterwards will reuse those colors, fonts, components, and brand feel.

Inputs Claude accepts

- Company name and a short blurb or mission statement
- Logo (PNG)
- GitHub repository (optional but powerful)
- Website URL (optional)
- Existing Figma project (optional)
- Brand assets and notes about the feel of buttons, accents, components, etc.

What Claude generates

- Typography rules (primary and secondary fonts, hierarchy logic)
- Color palette (primary, secondary, accents, neutrals)
- Components (buttons, cards, badges, tags, input fields, icons)
- Spacing, sizing, and shape standards
- Example previews (landing page mock, mobile preview, marketing UI kit)

Process

1. If you already have a brand: drop in your logo, GitHub repo, and website URL. Claude scrapes existing assets and builds your design system from them.

2. If you're starting from scratch: brainstorm the brand concept in regular Claude Chat first (mission, audience, color palette, typography). Don't burn Design tokens on brainstorming.
3. Submit the brand concept Markdown file plus the logo into "Create New Design System."
4. Wait roughly 10 to 15 minutes for ingestion and verification.
5. Review each generated section. Approve what looks right or leave specific feedback (e.g., "the logo should not be modified from the PNG I uploaded").
6. Publish the design system. You can optionally make it the default for new projects.

Token impact

In the Tally example, building the design system used roughly 6% of a Max 20x weekly quota with no GitHub repo provided. The more code and assets you give it, the more it eats. Be selective: Claude does well with just colors, logo, typography, and a few notes about feel. You usually don't need to give it an entire GitHub repo.

IV. The Four In-Canvas Iteration Tools

Once you're inside a project, these four tools let you iterate without burning tokens on imprecise written descriptions.

1. **Comment:** Click any element on the canvas, leave a comment, send it to Claude. Forces you to be element-specific and reduces ambiguity.
2. **Inline Edit:** Directly edit text, font size, or color yourself in the canvas. Claude applies the change with no prompt needed. Lowest-token option for small fixes.
3. **Draw:** Circle a region of the screen and leave a typed note. Best for non-element things like gradients or background sections (not for clickable elements). Currently buggy in research preview, the typed comment can get hidden under UI.
4. **Tweaks Panel:** Ask Claude for a panel of variations ("give me a bunch of tweaks I can play around with"), then toggle between options like palette, accent hue, font, hero layout, texture, card style, and chrome without sending new prompts. Massive token saver and creative unlock.

Strategy

Reach for Inline Edit first for small fixes, the Tweaks Panel for exploring options, Comment for element-specific feedback, and Draw only when there is no actual element to click on.

V. The Full Brand-Building Workflow

The masterclass walks through building a fictional finance brand called "Tally" end-to-end. The same workflow applies to any brand: brainstorm, build the design system, then ship pitch deck, landing page, app prototype, and launch video.

Step 1: Ideate the Brand in Claude Chat

Use regular Claude (NOT Claude Design) to:

- Brainstorm the brand concept (name, mission, audience, voice, positioning)
- Generate logo concepts and a color palette
- Produce a brand concept Markdown doc you'll reuse everywhere

Step 2: Create the Design System

Bring the brand concept Markdown plus the final logo PNG into Claude Design "Create Design System." Iterate on the verification screens. Be specific in feedback when Claude alters your logo (this happens frequently).

Step 3: Build the Pitch Deck

- New project, Slide Deck, choose your design system.
- In a separate Claude Chat tab, ask Claude to research the market and produce a Markdown pitch deck outline (structure only, NOT a built deck).
- Paste the outline plus brand concept into Claude Design with a build prompt.
- Use the Tweaks Panel to play with cover style, background texture (warm haze, hairline, dot grid), accent color, slide chrome.
- Iterate with inline edits and present.

Step 4: Build the Landing Page

- Go straight to high-fidelity. Skip wireframes for single-page sites; wireframes are better for multi-page funnels or app flows.
- Add a sketch (rough labeled boxes for hero text, subtext, nav bar, animation video) so Claude aligns on layout BEFORE it builds.
- Drop in a custom background video. Nate generated one in Kling 2.0 from a logo image as both start frame and end frame for a clean loop.
- Paste the brand concept Markdown.
- Prompt for the full landing page using the design system.
- Iterate using Tweaks (texture strength, hero layout split or stacked, headline font, video frame style, watermark).

Step 5: Build the Mobile App Prototype

- Brainstorm in Claude Chat: ask for a "full spec for a mobile app, requirement doc, text-based, that I can turn into a high-fidelity breakdown."
- Drop the spec (often 800+ lines) into a new high-fidelity prototype using your design system. Specify mobile, not desktop.
- Answer Claude's clarifying questions: which screens, presentation format, interactivity, light/dark mode, fake data realism, number of variations.
- Result: full mockup canvas with onboarding flow, home screen, dark mode variants, all interactive.
- Iterate on dryness or blandness using the Tweaks Panel and Draw tool for layout bugs (e.g., status bar overlap).

Step 6: Build the Launch Video

- New project, From Template, Animation, set design system to your brand.
- Provide the HyperFrames Markdown skill file (linked in the video description) so Claude knows how to write motion-graphic HTML.
- Provide the brand concept Markdown.
- Prompt for a 20 to 30 second landscape launch video with a strong CTA at the end.
- Iterate with creative direction: "more dynamic, tell a story, more motion graphics, keep audience attention."
- Pull in HyperFrames catalog components (e.g., the App Showcase phone animation) by giving Claude the URL. Claude fetches the page, browses the GitHub repo, and integrates the element.
- No native MP4 export yet. Options: hand off to Claude Code to render, screen-record the full-screen presentation, or export ZIP/HTML.

Step 7: Generate a Brand Guidelines One-Pager (Bonus)

Ask Claude inside your design project to output complete text-based brand guidelines (logo rules, spacing, fonts, colors, buttons, accents). Paste that text into ChatGPT GPT Image 2 along with the logo PNG. It generates a polished one-page brand guidelines image. Tweak in Canva if specific fonts get garbled.

VI. The Inspiration Stack

For when you're feeling creatively stuck or want to recreate a polished aesthetic without starting from a blank canvas.

Inspiration sites

- **motions.ai** (also referenced as motionsites.ai): curated full-site and background-component examples. Copy the prompt directly into Claude Design and tell it to use your design system. Many free, paid plan is roughly $99 lifetime.
- **godly.website**: endless scroll of inspiration sites.
- **awwwards.com**: award-winning site gallery (also referred to as "awwwards with three Ws").
- **twentyfirst.dev**: component catalog (notifications, transitions, animated backgrounds, borders, buttons). Copy individual component prompts.
- **HyperFrames catalog**: pre-built motion-graphic elements (chromatic radial split, cross warp morph, glitch transitions, App Showcase phone animations, follow notifications). Give Claude the URL and it fetches the GitHub repo.

Tools used in the masterclass

- **GPT Image 2**: image generation (brand guidelines one pager)
- **Kie.ai with Nano Banana 2.0**: image generation (logo concepts, hero backgrounds).
- **Kie.ai with Kling 2.0**: video generation (animated logos, looping hero backgrounds). Use start frame plus end frame for clean loops.
- **VS Code with Claude Code**: deployment and continued iteration after Claude Design.
- **GitHub**: free private repo hosting.
- **Vercel**: free, GitHub-synced web hosting with auto-deploy on commit.

VII. Deployment Workflow (Claude Design to Live Site)

Once your project is ready inside Claude Design, here is the path to a live, public URL.

1. **Export:** Click Share, Download as ZIP. ("Hand off to Claude Code" exists but has been buggy.)
2. **Extract:** Place into a named local folder (e.g., lull_website/).
3. **Open in Claude Code:** Open the folder in VS Code, launch Claude Code.
4. **Verify locally:** Ask Claude Code to "open this on a local host so I can view it." Localhost URLs only work on your machine, not for shared visitors.
5. **Push to GitHub:** Tell Claude Code to push the project to a private GitHub repo. Authorize GitHub once if it's your first time.
6. **Connect Vercel:** Sign in to Vercel with your GitHub account. Add New Project, Import the repo, click Deploy. Roughly 60 seconds to a live URL.
7. **Common 404 fix:** If the Vercel URL returns 404, ask Claude Code to rename your main HTML file to index.html. Vercel serves from repo root by default.
8. **Iterate flow:** Make changes locally with Claude Code, view on localhost, then tell Claude Code to push to GitHub. Vercel auto-deploys to the live site within roughly 30 seconds.
9. **Mobile optimization:** Open browser dev tools (F12), switch to mobile view. Default Claude Design output is desktop-only; explicitly ask Claude Code to optimize for mobile.

VIII. Best Practices to Stretch Your Session Limit

What drains the limit fastest

- Running everything on Opus 4.7 (most expensive model)
- Brainstorming inside Claude Design
- Vague mega-prompts that send Claude down the wrong path
- Building five design systems instead of one
- Long polluted conversation threads (context bloat)

Practical token-saving moves

1. **Brainstorm in Claude Chat, NOT Claude Design.** Ideation, planning, and outline-writing happens in regular Claude. Bring only the refined plan into Design.
2. **Model-by-stage strategy.** Use Opus 4.7 for the planning phase and major builds. Switch to Sonnet 4.6 (or Haiku) for small iterations and tweaks. Sonnet 4.6 can generate full slide decks, animations, and videos once you've nailed your design system.
3. **Reference, don't describe.** Real screenshots, real sketches, real URLs, named examples (e.g., "Linear 2023 with higher density"). Avoid vague words like "clean" or "minimalistic."
4. **Don't use defaults.** Always provide your own copy, your own design system, and your own brand voice. Defaults equal AI slop.
5. **One visual dimension per prompt.** Don't ask for five changes in one message. Claude will only do one or two well, and disregard the rest. Iterate one feature at a time.

6. **Tell it what you don't want.** Negatives prevent corrections later (e.g., "no en dashes, no this font, no this color scheme").
7. **Use Tweaks, Inline Edit, and Comment instead of new prompts.** Each in-canvas action is dramatically cheaper than re-prompting.
8. **Sketches are powerful.** A simple labeled-box sketch upfront prevents Claude from making layout assumptions you'll need to undo later.
9. **Watch and stop early.** Watch the to-do list in real time. If Claude is going down the wrong path, stop it before it builds the wrong thing.
10. **Start a fresh session for very long threads.** When Claude says "Start a new chat to save XXX,XXX tokens of context," that's your cue. Export the project as ZIP, open a new Design project, drop the ZIP back in, and continue iterating with fresh context. (The /clear command may not fully empty the context window.)
11. **ZIP-export workaround.** When your Claude Design quota is gone, export the project to Claude Code and continue iterating there until Design resets. You're now burning a different meter.

IX. Known Limitations and Workarounds

- **Logos get altered.** Claude Design tends to redraw uploaded logos, especially detailed icons or logos with delicate elements (the slash on the Tally logo, for example). Simple text-based logos like "AIS" survive intact. Workaround: leave specific feedback ("don't modify the PNG I uploaded") and re-iterate, or fix in Canva post-export.
- **File upload cap.** Roughly 30 to 40 MB for video uploads. Eight to fifteen second clips upload reliably; twenty seconds sometimes works; longer videos do not.
- **No native MP4 video export.** Options: hand off to Claude Code to render, export ZIP or HTML, or screen-record the full-screen presentation.
- **No undo/revert button.** Unlike Lovable, you can't roll back to a previous prompt. Workarounds: use Tweaks (no commit until you toggle), or note the original values before you change them.
- **Draw feature is buggy.** The typed comment can get hidden under UI. Currently in research preview.
- **Mobile not auto-optimized.** Default output is desktop-only. Ask Claude Code (post-export) to add mobile responsiveness.

X. When NOT to Use Claude Design

To protect your weekly quota, skip Claude Design and use a different tool when:

- You're brainstorming or planning. Use regular Claude Chat.
- You're making a small manual fix (e.g., swapping a logo in Canva takes five seconds and costs no tokens).
- You can already export to PowerPoint, Figma, or Canva and finish the work there faster.
- You're wrestling with a single specific element that would be easier to drag in a static editor.

- You need to iterate at scale on a website you've already built. Move it to Claude Code where the meter is different.

The mindset shift: only use Claude Design when you specifically need its design surface. Otherwise, do the work where the tokens are cheaper or free.

XI. The B.R.A.N.D. Framework

Use this 5-step framework to keep every Claude Design project on track and within your weekly limit.

Letter	Step	Action	Focus
B	**Brainstorm**	Ideate, plan, and outline in regular Claude Chat. Bring only the refined plan into Design.	Save Design tokens.
R	**Reference**	Provide real screenshots, sketches, URLs, brand concept Markdown, and named examples. Avoid vague words.	Specificity over description.
A	**Architect**	Build ONE design system, build it well, share it across the team. Iterate over time, don't duplicate.	Foundation for consistency.
N	**Navigate**	Use Comment, Inline Edit, Draw, and Tweaks to iterate inside the canvas. One visual dimension per prompt.	In-canvas tools beat re-prompting.
D	**Distribute**	Export to ZIP, HTML, PowerPoint, or Canva, or hand off to Claude Code. Push to GitHub, sync to Vercel for live deployment.	Get the work out of Design.

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